AFTER ABOUT A decade-long delay, the National Stock Exchange of India (NSE) went public on September 24, in a ₹22,562-crore initial public offering (IPO). It was the second-largest IPO in India after Hyundai Motor India's ₹27,870-crore offering in 2024. The issue was subscribed 5.7 times. Driving the listing ambitions was MD and CEO Ashishkumar Chauhan, who took over in 2022 when the NSE was dealing with the co-location controversy. Under him, the NSE worked through those issues and revived its listing plans.

Chauhan, who says organisations like the NSE are set up once in the lifetime of a nation, fondly remembers his association with the exchange since its inception. And he sees an even brighter future for NSE after the IPO.

"Over the next five years, we see the NSE evolving from being primarily identified as an equity and derivatives exchange into a genuine one-stop shop with deep liquidity across multiple asset classes," Chauhan says in an interview with *BT*. His relaxed demeanour belies the scale of the ambition behind that vision.

NEW STRATEGY

The NSE's next phase of growth will be driven by a combination of new products, newer market segments, technology, and deeper participation across the financial ecosystem.

"Commodity and energy markets are certainly an important part of the NSE's growth opportunity. The recent regulatory decision to allow FPIs (foreign portfolio investors) to participate in physically settled non-agricultural commodity derivatives can also help broaden participation in the commodity ecosystem," says Chauhan.

The NSE commenced operations in 1994, ushering in a new era of electronic screen-based trading of securities, while settlement in dematerialised securities followed in 1996. Derivatives trading began in 2000.

The rapid economic growth seen over the past 30 years has led to multi-fold growth for NSE as hundreds of companies tapped the stock market. That, in turn, has brought in large institutional investors as well as millions of retail investors into the ecosystem.

Chauhan points out that the NSE's premium turnover in the WTI (West Texas Intermediate) Crude Oil contract has surged from ₹875 crore in January 2026 to about ₹8,200 crore in September 2026. Similarly, in electricity futures, it now has more than 72% market share.

Analysts from PL Capital say the NSE has built a "holistic ecosystem through key market institutions." NSE Clearing, for instance, is the largest clearing corporation in India in terms of cleared value, they say. Separately, NSE Indices had 425 indices, spanning sectors, themes and strategies, as of March 2026, they said.

NSE IX, the international exchange in Gujarat's GIFT International Financial Services Centre, got the global access provider licence earlier this year, enabling it to offer an avenue for Indians to invest in global stock markets.

Last year, transaction charges driven by trading activity made up a large portion of the NSE's revenue. Officials say this should come down with new revenue lines such as data and connectivity, and indices growing at a fast pace. "If you look at the revenue composition, 80% volumes come from trading activity, 20% from related activities. Moving forward, we need to diversify the revenue stream," says Srinivas Injeti, Chairman, NSE, adding the organisation can also monetise data within what is permissible under the regulatory framework. "So, many other products could also be developed," says Srinivas.

ROBUST NUMBERS

The NSE's total income rose from ₹16,352 crore in FY24 to ₹18,713 crore in FY26. According to Srinivas,

INCREASED FOCUS ON DIVERSIFICATION

NSE has been the market leader in segments like equity cash and derivatives, but has been aggressively expanding in newer areas like commodities

In March 2026, it launched 10-gram gold futures contracts to broaden retail participation in commodities

